Dear Editor-in-Chief,

I am submitting my manuscript, "Robust Literature Discovery from Minimal Seeds: Validating LitDiscover on APS Citation Benchmarks and Live Surveys," for consideration as a Research Paper in Information Processing & Management.

The paper introduces LitDiscover, a queue-driven literature discovery engine that governs citation-graph traversal through three coordinated control mechanisms — bidirectional traversal, Pareto-filtered hub suppression, and yield-gated continuation — to recover a topic's bibliography from as few as one to five seed papers. I validate the system on a closed 709,803-paper APS citation benchmark against three landmark survey bibliographies, characterize the residual miss set structurally, and confirm via live validation on three open-domain surveys (via the Semantic Scholar API) that the same control logic transfers outside the closed-corpus setting. I believe this fits squarely within Information Processing & Management's scope at the intersection of system-level algorithmic contribution and information retrieval practice: the paper proposes a new retrieval architecture and validates it empirically, in the spirit of the journal's stated interest in both technical and applied information-processing research.

Conflicts of interest. I ask that Xiaobai Sun (Duke University) not be invited to review this manuscript. She is my PhD supervisor and her prior work is cited in the paper (Section 2), but she was not involved in this paper's design, execution, or writing and is not a co-author.

Use of generative AI. Generative AI tools (Claude) were used during the preparation of this work in two capacities: (1) as a coding assistant during development of the Python analysis pipeline (ground-truth extraction, traversal simulation, cold-start experiments, and figure generation), under my direction and with all methodological decisions, parameter choices, and result interpretation made and verified by me; and (2) as a writing and editing aid during manuscript drafting and LaTeX formatting. No generative AI tool is an author of this work, and I take full responsibility for the accuracy, integrity, and originality of all reported methods, results, and text. This is also declared in the manuscript itself per the journal's disclosure requirements.

CRediT authorship contribution statement. As sole author, I am responsible for all contribution roles: Conceptualization, Methodology, Software, Validation, Formal analysis, Investigation, Data curation, Writing – original draft, Writing – review & editing, and Visualization. This is also stated in the manuscript.

This manuscript is original, has not been published previously, and is not currently under review at any other journal or conference.

Thank you for considering my submission.

Sincerely, David Goh Department of Computer Science, University of Toronto daveed@cs.toronto.edu ORCID: 0009-0009-7241-6906